



Create A Game Yourself!

Remember good old *Arkanoid*? Now you can create your own using Game Maker from this month's *Digit* CD!

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If you've just read the article about young Shashank H R, you're probably itching to get started on a game of your own. Here, we'll create a simple, one-level version of that ever-loved classic, *Arkanoid*.

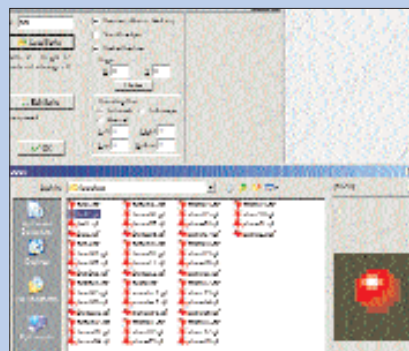


1 The Cast

After you've installed Game Maker from the *Digit* CD and fired it up, the first step is to add all the sprites you're going to use. Sprites are just images that will play different roles in the game. For this game, we'll need a bat, a ball, a wall and a brick. Select **Add > Add Sprite** and click on the Load Sprite button in the dialog. Game Maker comes bundled with a load of example sprites, so you don't have to hassle yourself making your own. Find the sprites here:

Ball: <Drive>:\Program Files\Game_Maker6\Sprites\various (pick any of the Ball icons from here)

Bat: <Drive>:\Program Files\Game_Maker6\Sprites\breakout\bat1.gif



Select a ball from the game's many samples

Brick: <Drive>:\Program Files\Game_Maker6\Sprites\breakout\stone01.gif

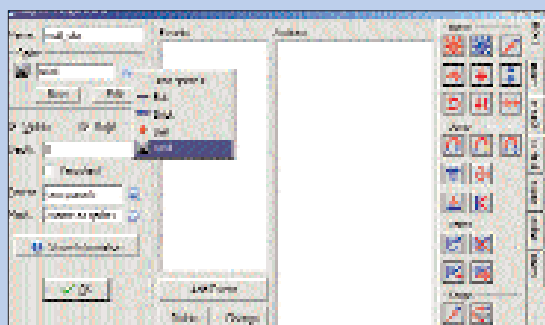
Wall: <Drive>:\Program Files\Game_Maker6\Sprites\pacman\wall.gif

Make sure you name the sprites appropriately.



2 Walls And Bricks

Just loading sprites isn't enough—you need to turn them into objects to make them interact with each other in the game. We'll start by creating an object for the wall. Go to **Add > Add**



Creating the Wall object

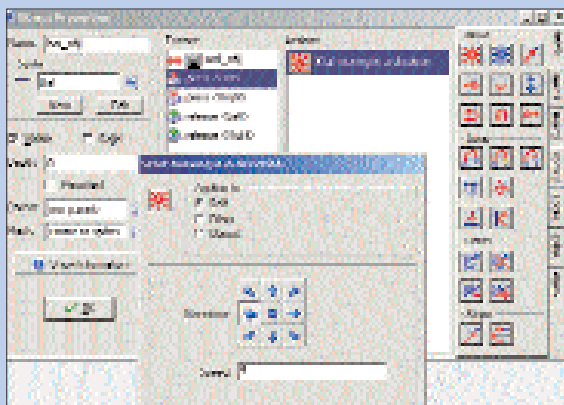
Object. Call the object "wall_obj" and click on the button under "Sprite" to choose the Wall sprite. This is going to be a solid object, so check the Solid checkbox.

Repeat the same procedure and create an object for the Brick as well.

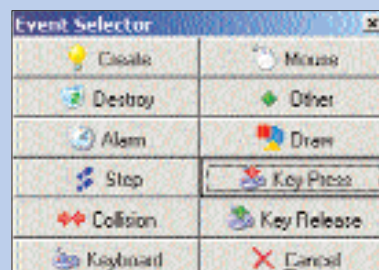


3 The Bat

We'll do more in the Add Object dialog this time. Once we've added a Bat object (the way we



Setting up the Bat



The Event selector

did for the wall), we need to define what it's going to do in the game:

(a) Move left when we press the left arrow; ditto for the right

(b) Stop when it touches the wall

For the first requirement, we'll create a Key Press event that tells the bat to move when one of the arrow keys is pressed. Click on the Add Event button and in the Event selector that comes up, click on Key Press and choose Left. From the Move panel on the left, drag the "Start Moving

in a Direction" icon (the red one with arrows in all directions) into the Actions region. In the dialog that comes up, depress the left arrow and set the speed to 5. Repeat this for a Right key press event.

We also need to stop the bat when the arrow keys are released, so repeat the same procedure for Key Release events for the left and right arrows, this time setting the speed to 0.

Finally, we also need to stop the bat when it touches the wall. Add a Collision event, and select the Wall object. Again, drag the Start Moving in a Direction icon and choose a speed of 0.



4 The Ball

The ball is the heart of the game, and we'll be creating lots of events here. The first thing we want it to do is move in a random